Cheng Chen

Prospective PhD Applicant

Tongji University · Electrical Engineering

2351445@tongji.edu.cn
chenceason10@gmail.com
ceasonen.github.io
github.com/ceasonen
Major rank 3/87
Shanghai, China



Summary

- EE undergrad at Tongji (rank **3/87**). Research on **multimodal AI** and **trustworthy AI**.
- Accepted papers at **IJCAI**, **IJCNN**, **ICANN**; submissions to **ACM MM** and **NeurIPS**.

Education

B.Eng. in Electrical Engineering, Tongji University, Shanghai — 2023.09 – Present
Major rank: **3/87**; CET-6: **519**.

Research

OrthKD: Extracting Generalized Clinical Knowledge from Heterogeneous Teachers for Lightweight Deployment — IJCAI 2026
C. Chen*, Y. Xu*, M. Cao. **Accepted; co-first; oral.**
Distill multiple clinical models into one small model without inheriting each teacher's bias.

Open-Vocabulary Audio-Visual Event Localization — ACM MM 2026
C. Chen* et al. **Under review; co-first. Initial score 4/4/4/4/3.**
Locate audio-visual events from any text query, with reliability-aware distillation.

Enabling Visual Reasoning in Text-Only LLMs via Symbolic Scene Descriptions — IJCNN 2026
W. Lei, M. Cao, C. Ye, Y. Xu, **C. Chen**. **Accepted; corresponding author.**
Describe scenes in symbols so text-only LLMs can reason about images.

Beyond Relevance: Counter-Evidence Planning in a Controlled Budgeted RAG Testbed — ICANN 2026
Y. Cai, Y. Xu, **C. Chen**. **Accepted; corresponding author.**
Plan retrieval under a fixed budget, including evidence that might disagree.

Neural-Operator Risk Assessment for Deployable Risk Triage — NeurIPS 2026
C. Chen et al. **Under review; first author.**
Flag risky neural-operator outputs in one forward pass.

Awards

National 2nd Prize, Global Campus AI Algorithm Elite Competition — 2025
National 3rd Prize, Embedded Chip & System Design Competition — 2025

Skills

- **Experiments:** PyTorch — training, baselines, ablations, and writing up what actually happened.
- **Writing:** English papers in LaTeX; first author, co-first, and corresponding author experience.